United Arab Emirates · Minister of Energy · 2026-06-10

UAE Energy Transition and Hydrogen Strategy Brief

Country: United Arab Emirates (ARE) · Region: GCC

STRATEGIC OVERVIEW

UAE leads regional energy transition through $54 billion clean energy investments by 2030. National Hydrogen Strategy targets 25% global low-carbon hydrogen market share by 2030. Major bilateral partnerships with Germany, Japan, South Korea accelerate technology transfer and offtake agreements. ADNOC expanding blue hydrogen capacity to 5 million tons annually. Masdar developing 10 GW green hydrogen projects across UAE, Egypt, Azerbaijan.

TALKING POINTS

- UAE commits 30% renewable energy by 2030 (UAE Energy Strategy 2050)
- Seven hydrogen projects operational, 25 under development worth $15 billion
- Germany-UAE hydrogen accord enables 2025 first shipments
- ADNOC captures 90% CO2 from hydrogen production facilities
- Japan partnership includes ammonia supply chain from 2026

RISKS & SENSITIVITIES

- EU Carbon Border Adjustment impacts blue hydrogen competitiveness post-2026
- Regional competition from Saudi Arabia's NEOM hydrogen megaproject
- Technology costs remain 40% above commercial viability targets

COOPERATION OPPORTUNITIES

- First-mover advantage in certified low-carbon hydrogen exports to Asia
- Abu Dhabi Hydrogen Alliance consolidates $30 billion investment pipeline
- COP28 legacy positions UAE as global energy transition finance hub

SOURCES & CONFIDENCE

Sources: UAE Energy Strategy 2050 · IRENA, 2024 · IEA Hydrogen Review, 2024 · ADNOC Sustainability Report, 2024 · UAE-Germany Joint Declaration, 2024
Confidence: high